To answer this question, we must first look at two more concepts from DDD: model and bounded context.

4.3.2 Model and bounded context

Domains, *subdomains*, and *business capabilities* are terms used to describe the business. At the same time, they form a good blueprint for system boundaries, data, and teams. They describe the *problem space*. However, it is not enough to define a problem; we also need to identify a solution!

Model and *bounded context* in DDD come from the solution space. We create the *model* to solve the problem. These two terms are essential to a data mesh. Data use cases (analytical use cases) are usually different from the software use cases, so we need to design other models for these purposes.

A *model* is a simplification and abstraction of a fragment of reality. Models are always created for a specific purpose and to solve a particular problem. For example, a floor plan is a model of a part of the building. It is created to arrange a floor, place internal doors, and partition walls, but it should not be used to calculate the building's structural strength! These are the boundaries of its usage; such boundaries are called in DDD the *bounded context*.

Figure 4.15 shows the relation between *model*, *bounded context*, and *domain*. The floor-plan model, and the building construction model, are separated by boundaries of their bounded contexts: floor-planning bounded context and design-building bounded context. Both contexts are located in different domains: the Plan Floor domain and Design Building domain.